KELROY JAMES

Operational Risk & Supply Chain Assurance | Third-Party & Supplier Assurance | Governance, Risk & Compliance

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Operational risk and supply chain assurance manager who designs first-line controls that keep working after the person who built them has moved on. Works from the evidence: the record, the physical stock and the person accountable for each, and closes the gap where they disagree. Seeking operational risk, supply chain assurance, and supplier and third-party risk roles, bringing Royal Navy logistics experience, ISO Lead Auditor qualifications and an MSc in progress.

Selected result: identified and corrected £2.4M of misallocated expenditure on an adjacent account, tracing it to an unowned interface between the contractual and accounting routes.

Core Skills: Operational Risk & Resilience | Supply Chain Assurance | Control Design & Testing | Third-Party & Contractor Assurance | Loss Investigation & Root-Cause Analysis | Governance, Risk & Compliance (Three Lines Model) | First-Line Risk Ownership (1LOD) | ISO/IEC 27001, 42001, 27701 Lead Auditor

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Supply Chain Manager (Petty Officer)

Royal Navy, specialist unit | September 2026 - Present

- **Current Scope:** Supply chain accountability, compliance and movements support for a high-readiness specialist unit.

Supply Chain Manager (Petty Officer) and Departmental Training Coordinator

Royal Navy, Front-Line Warship | May 2024 - September 2026

- **Compliance Recovery:** Led the remediation of an account rated unsatisfactory at independent inspection, restoring full compliance within 12 months and sustaining it through pre-deployment assurance.
- **Competency Assurance:** Departmental training coordinator through three formal logistics inspections: planned and oversaw the training programmes taking junior personnel through workplace task books for promotion, evidencing competence as part of the department's compliance position.
- **Financial Control & Third-Party Reconciliation:** Identified £2.4M in misallocated expenditure on an adjacent account during a contractor-supported upkeep period, tracing it to an unowned interface between the contractual and accounting routes; reconciled enterprise data with the prime contractor and with Defence Equipment and Support, the procurement body of the Ministry of Defence, and co-designed an analytics dashboard for continuous oversight.
- **Loss Reduction:** Cut financial liability by 80% by closing 15 loss cases through asset verification and investigation.
- **Control Design:** Redesigned first-line controls using ISO management-systems standards, Lean Six Sigma and the Three Lines Model; recommendations submitted to the policy authority as a proposed policy instruction.
- **Training & Awareness:** Designed and delivered training on the purpose behind the monthly compliance-monitoring routine, reframing it for the team as governance, risk and compliance work rather than administration; extended into "Empowerment Day," a junior-personnel development programme adopted as recurring departmental practice.
- **Strategic Research:** Selected as a 1SL Richmond Fellow at the Royal Navy Strategic Studies Centre (April 2025 - April 2026), contributing to quarterly research themes and red-team exercises on maritime strategy.

Supply Chain and Global Movements (Petty Officer)

Royal Navy, Wildcat Maritime Force | April 2022 - May 2024

- **Asset Accountability:** Consolidated a dispersed, effectively unauditable asset base into a single accountable holding and closed 14 major loss investigations through evidence-based reconciliation.
- **Movements & Customs Compliance:** Ran global movements coordination alongside stores accountability, covering international freight, customs documentation and third-party freight and handling partners.
- **Team Leadership:** Led a nine-person team through concurrent operational commitments, including support to a £5M weapons trial; six of the nine have since been promoted.
- **Delivery Under Pressure:** Turned round a rejected compliance consignment in three days to protect a fixed external deadline, and recovered a mid-exercise equipment shortfall with three hours to spare.

Section Head, Supply Chain (Petty Officer)

Royal Navy, Surface Flotilla Engineering Support | June 2021 - April 2022

- **Financial Accountability:** First-line (Tier 1) approver of record, as section head, for stock and inventory valued between £10M and £25M.
- **Compliance Assurance:** Owned first-line compliance-tool testing across three ship classes from the point of promotion.
- **Lean Delivery:** Led the logistics workstream of a lean-maintenance pilot: £145,674 of stores handled with zero losses on return, and the highest rate of demands placed on time of any comparable support period that year.
- **Innovation:** Selected for the 12-week Percy Hobart Fellowship, a Defence innovation programme, and delivered a mentored capability project on consignment-tracking process redesign.

Earlier Royal Navy Postings - Assurance, Movements and Leadership

Royal Navy, various units | 2008 - 2021

- **Fleet Stores Coordination Cell, 2019:** Provided 24/7 watchkeeping cover for fleet-wide defect logistics across three concurrent global commitments; part of the five-person team awarded the Herbert Lott Efficiency Award.
- **Fleet Diving Squadron:** A high-readiness unit relied on external systems to locate its equipment. Led delivery of its own tracking capability under PRINCE2, from stakeholder mapping and contractor integration to customs-compliant procedures, ending a 200-mile round trip for consignment labels.
- **NATO SHAPE, 2015-16:** As the only Royal Navy sailor in a tri-service unit, rebuilt a non-compliant logistics account, including ammunition: established a Central Records Branch, new naming conventions and a new record template, restoring full compliance within nine months.
- **Dangerous Goods Training:** Delivered safety-critical dangerous goods training to explosive ordnance disposal personnel and mentored colleagues ahead of promotion courses without senior supervision; awarded the Chief Naval Logistics Officer's Award (2018).
- **Falkland Islands:** As Low Value Procurement Officer, sole point of contact for the deployed unit's financial and asset compliance, cutting low-value transaction volume by 80%.

GIS Analyst & Infrastructure Planner - Critical National Infrastructure

St Vincent Electricity Services | 1996 - 2008

- **GIS Mapping:** Led the GPS geo-tagging of national grid infrastructure, the mapping work that underpinned an Esri Special Achievement in GIS award.
- **Progression:** Advanced over twelve years from front-line operations to infrastructure planning through self-directed development, in a regulated utility environment.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022, 42001:2023 and 27701:2025 Lead Auditor; Fellow of Management Systems Auditing (FellowMSA).
- MSc Supply Chain and Logistics Management (Defence Logistics Staff Course), University of Lincoln, accredited by CIPS, CILT and IEMA - in progress, April 2025 - March 2027; route to MCIPS.
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt, Star Global College of Workforce Development - February 2026.
- MicroMasters, Supply Chain Management and Advanced Network Design, MIT Center for Transportation & Logistics - five core courses complete; comprehensive exam pending for full award.
- BSc (Hons) Logistics and Operations Management (2:1), Aston University.
- Strategic Risk Leadership: Data, Empathy and Assurance, University of Illinois - in progress, from September 2026 (risk discovery, enterprise risk management tools, strategic internal auditing).
- Information Assurance Analysis, Johns Hopkins University - February 2026, including AI in industrial control systems security and advanced network security.
- Cyber Security: Technology and Governance, Royal Holloway, University of London - February 2026, including security management and governance.
- Developing Industrial Internet of Things, University of Colorado Boulder - December 2025, including industrial IoT markets and security.
- MicroMasters, Predictive Analytics using Python, University of Edinburgh - 2021 - 2022.
- Professional Award in Cyber Security & OSINT, Abertay University - Distinction; CompTIA PenTest+ (valid to 2027).

AVAILABILITY

Available for permanent appointment from April 2028. Open before that date to resettlement work attachments, secondments and structured veteran or service-leaver hiring routes.

Last Updated: October 2026